

Peripherals and Docking Station Guide

Northgate Group — IT Service Desk Manual | Version 3.1 | Effective 1 January 2026 | Owner: IT Operations

1. Scope

This guide covers docking stations, external monitors, printers, headsets and other peripherals issued with a company laptop, together with the entitlement rules for requesting them.

2. Docking Station Not Detected (Fault Code E-42)

Fault code E-42 covers a docking station that the laptop does not enumerate, which typically presents as external monitors staying blank, the wired network dropping and peripherals on the dock going dead at the same time.

- Disconnect the dock from the laptop and from mains power, wait 30 seconds, reconnect power first and then the laptop.
- Confirm the dock's own power supply is connected; a dock drawing power only from the laptop will enumerate intermittently.
- Reseat the cable at both ends and test a different cable, because the cable is the most common point of failure.
- Test the dock with another laptop if one is available, which isolates the fault to the dock or to the laptop port.
- Where monitors stay blank but the network works through the dock, the fault is usually the display driver rather than the dock.

If the dock is still not detected after these steps, raise a hardware issue ticket with the device type set to docking station and the fault code set to E-42, and list the steps already tried.

3. External Monitors

Each employee is entitled to one external monitor at their primary work location, and a second monitor where the role involves sustained work across multiple applications and the line manager confirms the need. Remote workers approved for three or more remote days per week may request a monitor for the home location as set out in the Remote Work Policy.

A monitor that shows no picture should be tested on a different input and with a different cable before a ticket is raised. A monitor connected through a dock affected by fault code E-42 will appear faulty even though the monitor itself is working.

4. Printers

Office printers are published automatically to company laptops on the corporate network. A printer that does not appear should be reinstalled from the Company Portal. Printing over the VPN is not supported for home printers; use the local print queue instead.

Persistent paper jams, streaking and toner alerts are handled by the facilities team rather than the service desk. Report the printer's asset number when raising the request so the correct device is identified.

5. Headsets and Webcams

A headset is issued to every employee. A replacement is provided on a like-for-like basis when the original fails, without manager approval. Audio problems in meetings are most often caused by the wrong input or

output device being selected in the conferencing client rather than by a faulty headset, so check the device selection before raising a ticket.

6. Returning Equipment

Peripherals remain company property and are returned on termination of employment or when an employee transfers to a role with a different entitlement. Faulty items are returned when the replacement is collected. Unreturned items are recorded against the employee's asset register entry.